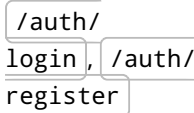


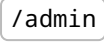
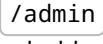
Ideate UI/UX Review

1. Executive Summary

The Ideate platform aims to help teams collect and prioritise ideas democratically. While the core workflow (projects → proposals → voting) is functional, numerous usability and polish issues detract from the overall experience. Pages frequently expose logged-in navigation when they shouldn't, translation support is inconsistent and resets between pages, and dark-mode and mobile styling need refinement. In its current state Ideate feels like a beta product; it requires significant improvements in authentication flows, localisation, responsive design and visual polish before it can compete with established tools like Linear or Notion.

2. Critical Issues

Issue	Page(s)	Observation & Impact	Recommendation
Sign-out doesn't work	Login/Register	After clicking Sign Out the left navigation remains visible and the app still shows logged-in pages (dashboard links, project listings etc.) ¹ . This means users never truly log out and could expose sensitive project data on shared devices.	Ensure that signing out clears the user session and redirects to a dedicated public homepage with no navigation components from the logged-in interface.
Login and register pages display logged-in navigation		The login and registration forms show the full sidebar (Home, Dashboard, Projects, Profile) and a "Sign Out" link ¹ ² . This is confusing and suggests the user is already logged in.	Use a clean, minimal layout for unauthenticated pages without any logged-in navigation. Remove the "Sign Out" link from these pages.
Locale resets to English on navigation	All pages	Switching to Romanian (via the language toggle) only persists on the current page. Navigating to another page reverts back to English (e.g., going from Projects to Dashboard flips back to EN). This breaks the localisation experience and makes the product feel unfinished ³ .	Persist the selected locale in user preferences or a URL parameter. Ensure that all page navigations respect the chosen language until changed by the user.

Issue	Page(s)	Observation & Impact	Recommendation
Many UI strings not translated into Romanian	Dashboard, Projects list, Project detail, Create Project, New Proposal, Profile	Even when Romanian is selected, page titles ("Dashboard", "Projects"), section headings ("Your Projects", "Your Proposals"), button labels ("Create Project", "New Proposal"), and form placeholders remain in English ⁴ ⁵ . In some places (projects list) only navigation labels change.	Provide complete translations for all visible strings. Use i18n keys consistently so that translation applies uniformly across components.
Admin page unreachable/no feedback		Navigating to  simply redirects to the dashboard without any message. Users with insufficient permissions aren't told why they can't access the page.	Display a clear "403 – Access Denied" page with an explanation rather than silently redirecting.
Persistent PWA install pop-up obscures UI	All pages	A "Install Ideate" pop-up appears at the bottom right on every page, often covering content or action buttons (e.g., the submit button in the New Proposal panel). It reappears even after closing ⁶ .	Either show the PWA install prompt only once per session or place it in a less intrusive location. Remember dismissal for the current session.

3. Major Issues

Issue	Page(s)	Observation & Impact	Recommendation
Project and proposal creation forms not localized	 , New Proposal panel	Labels and placeholder text remain in English ("Create New Project", "Describe what this project is about...", "What do you propose?") even in Romanian mode ⁷ .	Translate all form labels, hints and tooltips. Consider using shorter placeholder text and helper text beneath fields.
Voting interaction unclear	Proposal cards	The vote buttons (thumb up/down) do not indicate whether the user has already voted or how to change the vote. Users may not realise that clicking again toggles their vote.	Highlight the selected vote state (e.g., filled icons or colour changes). Provide hover text ("Click again to remove your vote").

Issue	Page(s)	Observation & Impact	Recommendation
Profile editing fields unlabeled in Romanian		The profile page has “First Name” and “Last Name” fields with English placeholders even after switching to RO. The Save button also remains English.	Translate field labels and buttons; indicate required fields clearly.
Spacing issues and inconsistent alignment	Dashboard, Projects, Profile	Some cards have different padding and alignment; counters and icons are not perfectly vertically aligned  . This reduces the professional feel.	Audit spacing and alignments across components. Use consistent margin/padding values.
No confirmation on destructive actions	Project Delete	There is a red “Delete” button on project pages. Clicking it immediately deletes the project without confirmation. This could lead to accidental data loss.	Add a modal confirmation before permanently deleting a project.
Search bar appears non-functional	Header across all pages	The search bar placeholder says “Search projects & proposals...” but typing doesn’t filter or redirect. There’s no search result page.	Either implement search functionality or remove/disable the bar until it works.

4. Minor Issues

Issue	Page(s)	Observation & Impact	Recommendation
Colour contrast of secondary text in dark mode	Dark theme	In dark mode, grey text for descriptions and timestamps has low contrast against dark card backgrounds (e.g., deadlines on project cards). Some users may struggle to read it  .	Increase contrast (e.g., use lighter grey or white). Test against WCAG AA standards.
Left navigation resets scroll position	Dashboard → Project detail	When viewing long pages like the project detail with many proposals, clicking back to projects resets the left navigation state (collapses/expands) unexpectedly.	Maintain nav state and highlight the current section; avoid jumps when navigating back.

Issue	Page(s)	Observation & Impact	Recommendation
No tooltip on icons	Various	Icons such as PDF/CSV export, edit, language, theme toggles lack hover tooltips. Users may not know what they do.	Add descriptive tooltips to all icon buttons.
Date format fixed to U.S. mm/dd/yyyy	Project list, forms	The deadline picker uses mm/dd/yyyy and displays U.S. style dates ("2/23/2026"). Romanian users generally expect dd.mm.yyyy format.	Localise date formats based on locale; use a date-picker library that supports localisation.

5. i18n Report (Romanian Translation)

Below is a list of strings that remained in English when the locale was set to RO:

Page	English strings observed	Notes
Dashboard	"Dashboard"; "Projects", "Proposals", "Total Votes", "Comments"; "Your Projects", "Your Proposals", "Your Recent Votes", "Recent Activity"; "Latest discussions across all projects"; "No recent activity."	Only the sidebar changed to "Acasa", "Proiecte", etc. All dashboard section titles and counters remained in English ⁴ .
Projects list	Page title "Projects"; subtitle "2 projects total"; button "Create Project"; card details "Created", "Deadline" and the project description of the template project (English) ⁵ .	Navigation labels changed to Romanian, but the main UI stayed English.
Create Project form	"Create New Project", "Set up a new idea prioritization project for your team", "Project Title", "Description", "Optional: Provide context and guidelines for participants", "Deadline", "Status", "Draft projects are not visible to participants", "Create Project", "Cancel"	None of these strings had a Romanian version ⁷ .
Project detail page	Button labels "Back to Projects", "PDF", "CSV", "Edit", "Delete"; status "active" and countdown "remaining"; section titles "Description", "Created", "Last Updated", "Proposals"; button "+ New Proposal"; table headings for votes and comments	Only the sidebar shows Romanian section names; the rest remains English.
New Proposal panel	"New Proposal", "Title", "What do you propose?", "Description (optional)", "Explain your proposal in detail...", "Your initial vote", "Pro", "Contra", "Submit Proposal"	Nothing translated; even the voting labels appear partly English (Pro/Contra mix) ¹⁰ .

Page	English strings observed	Notes
Profile page	Section titles “Profile”, “Account”, “Email”, “Role”, “Member Since”, “Display Name”, “Edit Profile”, “First Name”, “Last Name”, “Save Changes”, “Your Projects”, “Your Proposals”	Only the navigation changed to “Profil” and “Delogare”.
General	“Sign Out” appears as “Delogare” only when the user toggles to Romanian; it resets to “Sign Out” on page change. Dates and times remain in English format.	

Additionally, some Romanian translations sound unnatural or inconsistent. For example, “Delogare” is acceptable but many Romanian sites use “Deconectare” for “Sign Out”. “Acasa” (Home) and “Proiecte” are correct, but “Dashboard” could be “Tablou de bord” rather than leaving the English term.

6. Dark Mode Report

Issue	Description
Low contrast for secondary text	In dark mode, grey text describing projects, deadlines, and proposal details blends into the dark cards, making it difficult to read  .
No colour change for some buttons	The “active” status badge uses bright green which looks good, but the “Create Project” button stays white with dark text, drawing little attention in dark mode. Use accent colours that stand out on dark backgrounds.
Persistent PWA install pop-up	The “Install Ideate” banner remains light coloured, clashing with dark mode and covering content. It should adopt dark styling or be repositioned.
Missing theme toggle label	The theme toggle icon opens a drop-down (Light/Dark/System) but there is no label or tooltip. Users may not realise it’s for dark mode.
Scrollbar styling	The custom dark scrollbar only appears on some pages. On longer pages like the profile, the default light scrollbar stands out and looks unpolished.

7. Mobile Report

Limitations: The review environment did not allow precise browser window resizing, so testing relied on approximate observations. However, some responsive behaviour could be inferred.

- **Sidebar:** The left navigation takes up significant space and doesn’t collapse by default. On small widths (observed when the window temporarily collapsed), the navigation collapsed unexpectedly but lacked a visible toggle to reopen it. This could confuse mobile users.
- **Project cards:** Two project cards sit side by side on desktop. On narrow widths they should stack vertically. During a partial window shrink the cards became squished; there were no breakpoints observed to adjust spacing.
- **Forms:** The project and proposal creation forms use wide input fields and side-by-side layout (e.g., first/last name). On a mobile screen they likely become cramped; the placeholder text is lengthy and may wrap awkwardly.

- **PWA banner:** The persistent “Install Ideate” banner consumes valuable vertical space on mobile screens, potentially hiding action buttons.
- **Top bar icons:** The language and theme toggles are small; on mobile they may be hard to tap. Provide larger touch targets or move them into a menu.

8. UX Flow Observations

- **First-time experience:** The homepage immediately redirects to the dashboard if a session cookie exists. There is no marketing or explanation of the product’s value, which can confuse new users.
- **Project creation:** Creating a project requires selecting a deadline with an American date format and entering a title/description. The date picker closes automatically after selecting a date but there is no visual confirmation; first-time users may not realise the date was set.
- **Proposal voting:** The voting mechanism is simple but not intuitive. There is no explanation of what “Pro” or “Contra” means, nor how many votes a user can cast. Users could mistakenly click multiple times and remove their vote.
- **Navigation:** The sidebar remains visible even on small screens, but collapses unpredictably when switching languages or resizing. A hamburger menu would provide clearer navigation on mobile.
- **Error handling:** No error messages appear when submitting empty forms or invalid data. For example, creating a project with no title simply doesn’t proceed without feedback. Validation errors should be surfaced near the input field.
- **Feedback on actions:** Many actions (creating projects, proposals, voting) succeed silently. Showing toast notifications or success messages would reassure users.

9. Comparison to Linear, Notion, and Slido

Platforms like **Linear.app**, **Notion** and **Slido** offer polished, intuitive experiences. They maintain consistent localisation, responsive design, and clear status messages. Linear’s project boards and Notion’s databases provide fluid drag-and-drop and inline editing; Slido’s voting interface is simple and visually appealing. In contrast, Ideate feels rough — translation is incomplete, actions lack feedback, and dark mode/mobile styles need work. The overall polish and reliability are below the standard set by modern SaaS products. To compete, Ideate should prioritise fixing critical bugs (logout, locale persistence), completing translations, refining the dark theme, and implementing responsive layouts.

1 8 Ideate - Democratic Idea Prioritization

<https://idea.surmont.co/auth/login>

2 Ideate - Democratic Idea Prioritization

<https://idea.surmont.co/auth/register>

3 4 Ideate - Democratic Idea Prioritization

<https://idea.surmont.co/dashboard>

5 9 Ideate - Democratic Idea Prioritization

<https://idea.surmont.co/projects>

6 10 UI Review Test | Ideate

<https://idea.surmont.co/projects/a7bc9e8d-6635-4fae-9e03-14edcd0a852a>

7 Ideate - Democratic Idea Prioritization
<https://idea.surmont.co/projects/new>